



NetBSD is considered the most widely ported OS, capable of running on over 50+ hardware architectures—including a PS2, and this toaster

Yahoo!

A long time user of and contributor to FreeBSD which powers many of its servers

Open source

system crashes midway during the installation, you can restart the system and try booting with ACPI disabled.

The next step is to allocate disk space. This is done in two steps—first a slice has to be created, and then partitions need to be created in the slice. For creating slices, the Fdisk partition editor is launched. Here you can view the partition table displaying the existing partitions in the drive, and the file systems on each. If unused space is available, that entry will already be highlighted and you can create a slice in that area

by using the **Create Slice** command option displayed on the page. The size to be allocated for the slice can be set next (“5G” to represent 5 GB), and finally the file system needs to be set. FB can only be installed on a file system with id 165, and this is the type preselected.

After a slice has been created, the boot manager installation screen appears. Here one can choose whether to install the FB boot manager, or just write a standard MBR with no boot manager, or leave the MBR unedited. Using the first option is recommended, since this automatically includes any existing entries in the present boot manager. It needs to be noted, that unlike the boot manager installation process in most Linux distros, there are no options to edit the entries or change the default settings. Nonetheless, the FB boot manager is satisfactory.

After the boot manager is installed, the disk label editor is launched which

can be used to carve out space within the slice for different mount points/disk labels. There is an auto option that can set the recommended partition labels and sizes without any intervention, and in most cases that is sufficient. If you would like to manually allocate space, you can first Create a partition, then allocate the space for it, and finally set a disk label. A / label denotes the root partition, without which the installa-

tion will not proceed. It is advised to allocate separate partitions for other mount points such as /usr and /var to segregate the system files from the rest, for ease of maintenance. If separately set, the size of the /usr partition needs to be the highest since this is where bulk of the programs and user settings are going to be stored. If the partitions look fine, the changes can be saved by using the Finish option.

Once the Finish option is selected, the distribution selection screen comes up. Here one can set the different broad categories of applications that need to be included in the installation. A brief description of the choices is also provided. Here it is best for first time users to choose the “X-User” option. This will install all packages and the X window system, without their source files—which are needed only if the user intends to customise the installation

by tweaking and compiling the source code. Selecting any option in this menu also brings up a screen asking for user permission to install the ports collection. Here it is recommended to choose Yes. The Ports system is described in the section on installing applications. After selecting the distribution option, you must proceed to the next step, by exiting this screen.

The next screen asks for the location of the installation files. The choice here is obvious—FB CD/DVD.

A final confirmation is sought before the process continues. Please note that so far no changes have been made to the disk. And if the process is aborted here, the changes made in Fdisk are not applied. So curious users can navigate unto this point without fear of data loss on the hard disk. Once the user gives his assent on this screen, the installation begins and doesn't require user interaction in between.

Once the installation is completed, a screen pops up offering the user the opportunity to set post-installation options. Do not skip this stage. On giving the go ahead here, a sequence of screens appear requiring user responses to different queries. Through these screens various system parameters are set. First, the detected network devices can be configured. If you are using dynamic IP based broadband connection through the LAN port, it is advised to plug the cable in and switch on the modem so that the DHCP settings are correctly detected.

Alternatively, if you are using a static IP for your system these values can also be entered. Other screens that offer to configure other services like FTP and NFS can be dismissed for the time being. Other options like time zone selection, mouse function testing can also be performed. Creating a user account is recommended at this stage, and one of the screens accomplishes that. It is critical to add a system manager password, since sans this it would not be possible to login into the freshly



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```
fset      Size(ST)      End      Name  PType  Desc  Subtype  Flags
      0         63         62      -    12    unused      0
      63    51199092    51199154    ad0s1    4    NTFS/HPFS/QNX    7
  51199155    40949685    92148839    ad0s2    8    freebsd    165
  92148840    1012095    93160934    ad0s3    4    linux swap    130
  93160935    24049305    117210239    -    12    unused      0

The following commands are supported (in upper or lower case):
= Use Entire Disk  G = set Drive Geometry  C = Create Slice  F = 'DD' mode
= Delete Slice    Z = Toggle Size Units  S = Set Bootable  | = Wizard m.
= Change Type     U = Undo All Changes  W = Write Changes

Press F1 or ? to get more help, arrow keys to select.
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Allocating disk space